OFFICIAL HANDBOOK

The Complete Photo Booth *Starter Guide*

Your definitive manual to running photobooth4u across laptops, tablets, professional photo printers, and vintage thermal receipt booths — online or 100% offline.

01

Laptop: Online & Offline

Windows & Mac Desktop App running 100% offline with local hotspot QR downloads, plus the Online Chrome booth with live cloud sync.

02

Tablet Kiosk Apps

Android APK with native USB OTG Epson drivers, and iPad running fullscreen kiosk mode with direct Apple AirPrint.

03

Photo Printing Masterclass

High-speed commercial dye-sub 2×6 strip auto-cutting, ultra-low-cost EcoTanks, and wireless Laptop Print Station setup.

04

Vintage Receipt Booth

Instant retro black-and-white strips on continuous thermal rolls with Vozy, Epson, Bluetooth, and automated razor cuts.

☆ The 3 Golden Rules for Flawless Events

1. Always Run a Test Session
Take 1 full photo session on-site before guests arrive. Verify camera focus, flash exposure, guest QR download, and physical print cut.

2. Lock Power & Cables
Keep laptop and tablet plugged into mains power. Use a camera dummy battery (AC adapter) so DSLR cameras never power off mid-event.

3. Trust Your Offline Setup
Never rely solely on venue Wi-Fi. The Offline Desktop App and Android APK work 100% without internet. Guests download photos locally!

Running on a Laptop: Online & Offline

The laptop is the powerhouse of professional event booths: supporting DSLR tethering, dual-screen HDMI mirror displays, and direct USB connection to commercial high-speed printers.

Laptop Desktop App (Offline)

100% NO INTERNET

Available for Windows 10/11 (.exe) and macOS 11+ (.dmg). Built specifically for remote venues, outdoor weddings, basements, and venues with zero Wi-Fi.

1. **Local Booth Wi-Fi Hotspot**
   The laptop turns on a mobile hotspot (or connects to an offline portable router). Guests join that Wi-Fi network.
2. **Instant Local QR Downloads**
   At session end, the guest scans the on-screen QR. Their phone downloads the high-res photo straight from the laptop — zero internet or data required!
3. **Built-in Background Printing**
   Talks directly to Windows and Mac print spoolers. Prints silently in the background with no pop-ups, no helper tools, and no internet.
4. **DSLR Tethering & Dual Screen**
   Connect Canon, Nikon, or Sony via USB. Press `Win + P` → **Extend** to display a live countdown mirror on a TV facing the guests.

Chrome Web Booth (Online)

CLOUD GALLERIES

Open **photobooth4u.netlify.app** in Google Chrome on any computer. Perfect for venues with reliable Wi-Fi where instant cloud galleries are desired.

1. **Live Online Cloud Gallery**
   Photos upload instantly to your secured cloud event album. Guests scan the QR to open their private online link.
2. **The Print Helper Utility**
   Open **photobooth4u-print-helper.exe** in the background. It intercepts print commands, eliminating Chrome's print dialog for true 1-click silent auto-printing.
3. **Smart Offline Protection**
   If venue Wi-Fi stumbles during the event, the web app automatically queues photos in browser memory and syncs them to the cloud the moment internet returns.
4. **Remote Monitor & Share Station**
   Any secondary device can open your event's live gallery URL to act as an iPad sharing station or slideshow kiosk.

Feature Comparison Matrix

FEATURE	LAPTOP DESKTOP APP (OFFLINE)	CHROME WEB BOOTH (ONLINE)
Venue Internet	**Zero required.** Operates 100% offline in isolated locations.	Requires Wi-Fi (with built-in offline queue safety net).
Guest QR Delivery	**Direct Local Wi-Fi:** Served instantly from laptop over local IP.	**Cloud URL:** Served via public internet link to event album.
Silent Auto-Print	**Built-in natively.** No extra applications needed.	Requires running the lightweight **Print Helper** in background.
Camera Support	Webcams, DSLR tethering (Canon/Nikon/Sony), and HDMI capture cards.	Webcams, USB capture cards, and virtual DSLR camera drivers.
Best Use Case	Weddings in mountains/beaches, convention halls, ticketed kiosks.	Corporate launches, venues with solid Wi-Fi, live cloud albums.

Using with Tablets: Android APK & iPad

Tablets provide an ultra-sleek, portable kiosk enclosure. Run fully autonomous guest sessions with front-facing cameras or connect external cameras and printers.

Android Tablet App (APK)

NATIVE USB & BT

Download the APK directly from **photobooth4u.netlify.app/downloads/**. Works on Android tablets running Android 7.0 or newer.

1. **Activate Once with Lifetime Code**
   Connect to Wi-Fi once to activate your code. The app is then permanently authorized and runs 100% offline.
2. **Direct Wi-Fi Mopria & AirPrint**
   Go to **Print settings → Wi-Fi printer → Find Wi-Fi printers**. The tablet discovers network printers and prints without popup dialogs.
3. **Native USB OTG Ink-Tank Printing**
   Plug an OTG cable directly from the tablet into Epson L8050, L3210, etc. Built-in ESC/P2 drivers print borderless photos with no extra apps!
4. **Direct Bluetooth Thermal Printing**
   Pair thermal printers (Vozy, MPT, XP-80) via Bluetooth. The app prints retro receipt strips instantly with zero print dialogs.

iPad Kiosk (iOS Web App)

AIRPRINT READY

Runs cleanly on iPad Air, Pro, or standard 10.2" iPad using Safari's native standalone Progressive Web App (PWA) container.

1. **Create Fullscreen Web App**
   Open Safari, visit **photobooth4u.netlify.app**, tap the Share icon → **Add to Home Screen**. Launches with no browser bars!
2. **Native Apple AirPrint**
   In Print settings, choose AirPrint. Wirelessly prints directly to Canon SELPHY CP1300/1500, Epson, Brother, and HP on the same Wi-Fi.
3. **Enable Guided Access Mode**
   In iOS Settings → Accessibility → **Guided Access**. Triple-click the top power button to lock guests out of exiting the photo booth!
4. **High-End iPad Camera Sensor**
   Take advantage of Apple's Center Stage front cameras or rear 12MP Ultra-Wide lens for crisp, sharp photo strip captures.

The Bridge: Printing from Tablets to Commercial Dye-Sub Printers

LAPTOP PRINT STATION

The Challenge: Commercial dye-sub printers (DNP, HiTi, Citizen, Mitsubishi, Fuji) require specialized Windows or Mac USB drivers and cannot plug directly into an iPad or standard Android tablet.

The Solution — Laptop Print Station:

1. Connect Printer to Laptop
Plug your DNP or HiTi into a laptop with USB. Open **photobooth4u.netlify.app/print-station/** in Google Chrome.

2. Connect Both to Same Wi-Fi
Ensure your iPad/Android tablet and laptop are on the same Wi-Fi network (or portable router).

3. Auto-Print Wirelessly!
On the tablet, select *Send prints to → Laptop Print Station*. Every photo taken on the tablet prints instantly on the laptop's dye-sub!

The Complete Printing Process

How photo printing works: choosing between high-speed commercial dye-subs and ultra-low-cost continuous ink tanks, configuring 2×6 strip razor cuts, and setting up hands-free auto-print.

Commercial Dye-Sub Printers

12S · AUTO-CUT

Models: DNP (DS620, RX1HS), HiTi (P525L), Citizen (CX-02), Mitsubishi, Fuji ASK-300, Kodak 305.

- **High-Speed Event Duty:** 8 to 14 seconds per print. Prints drop out 100% dry and smudge-proof with a protective clear coat.
- **Roll Capacity:** 400 to 700 prints per roll — run entire weddings without reloading paper or ink!
- **Internal Strip Slicing:** Built-in razor blades automatically slice two 2×6 strips down the middle with zero manual trimming.

Pro-Tip: Add Printer Twice in Windows

Install the driver twice: name one *"DNP - 4x6 Postcard"* (standard cut) and the other *"DNP - 2x6 Strips"* (2-inch cut enabled). Assign each in booth settings!

Continuous Ink-Tank Printers

<₱0.50 PER PRINT

Models: Epson EcoTank Photo (6-color L8050, L18050), EcoTank (L3210, L3250), Canon MegaTank G620.

- **Unbeatable Profit Margins:** Less than ₱0.50 ($0.01) ink cost per photo. Thousands of prints from single refill bottles.
- **6-Color Photo Quality:** Models like the L8050 deliver laboratory-grade color reproduction and skin tones.
- **Android USB OTG Direct:** Plug USB straight into your Android tablet for automated driverless photo printing!

Glossy Photo Paper Settings

Always load premium inkjet glossy photo paper (180–260 gsm) and set driver paper type to *Epson Premium Glossy* for rich, non-smudging prints.

How 2×6 Photo Strip Auto-Cutting Works

1. Layout Generation
The booth automatically places two duplicate 2×6 strips side-by-side onto a single 4×6 (4R) digital canvas.

2. 2-Inch Cut Signal
In Windows/Mac Printing Preferences, enable **2-inch cut**. The driver signals the printer's internal cutter.

3. Sliced Down the Middle
During the final lamination pass, the razor cuts precisely at the 2-inch mark, dropping two finished strips!

Configuring 100% Hands-Free Auto-Print

1. **Open Print Settings**
   In the booth, tap **Photo Session → Print settings** (or **Setup → 4 Camera & printer**).
2. **Assign Printer per Paper Size**
   Tap your event's paper size (e.g. **4×6 in (4R)** or **2×6 in strip**) and pick your printer from the list. The app saves this choice.
3. **Run a Test Print & Verify**
   Tap **Test print**. Confirm that the print size is correct, colors are vibrant, and edges are borderless with no white trim.
4. **Enable Auto-Print Every Session**
   Check **Auto-print every session**. As soon as guests finish their photos, the physical print starts automatically — no operator clicks needed!

Vintage Receipt Photobooth (Thermal)

The surging retro photo booth trend: instant 1–2 second black-and-white dithered strips printed on continuous thermal paper rolls. Zero ink cartridges, zero ribbons, and pennies per roll.

80 mm Desktop POS (Auto-Cut) AUTOMATIC CUTTER

Featured Models: Vozy G80, Epson TM-T20III / TM-T88, Star Micronics TSP143, Munbyn ITPP047, Xprinter XP-N160II.

- **Paper Width:** 80 mm roll (~3.15 inches wide). Wide canvas for large, clear 3-photo vertical layouts.
- **Automated Razor Cut:** The printer's motorized guillotine cutter slices the receipt right below the QR code!
- **Connectivity:** USB to laptop, or Bluetooth / Network to Android tablet app.

58 mm Mobile Bluetooth (Battery) BATTERY POWERED

Featured Models: Vozy MP210 (battery), Vozy 50, MPT-II, PT-210, Goojprt, PeriPage, Phomemo.

- **Pocket Size:** Handheld mini printer with rechargeable lithium battery — perfect for mobile roaming booths (Rove).
- **Paper Width:** 58 mm roll (~2.28 inches wide) with serrated manual tear bar.
- **Bluetooth SPP:** Pairs wirelessly with Android tablet or phone with zero extra equipment.

Step-by-Step Android Bluetooth Setup (Zero Dialogs)

1 Pair Printer in Android Bluetooth Settings

Turn on the thermal printer. On the tablet, open **Settings → Connected devices → Bluetooth → Pair new device**. Tap your printer (named like `Vozy`, `G80`, `MP210`, `POS-80`, or `Printer001`). Enter PIN `0000` or `1234`.

2 Select Receipt Layout in the App

In photobooth4u, go to **Setup → Layout** and choose **Receipt**. The booth converts live camera frames into retro halftone black-and-white dithered graphics engineered for thermal paper.

3 Configure Thermal Printing

In **Print settings**, choose **Receipt 80 mm** or **Receipt 58 mm**. Enable **Bluetooth thermal receipt printer**, tap **Connect**, and select your paired Vozy/POS printer from the list.

4 Test Print & Auto-Print

Tap **Test print** — the printer feeds and prints a test header in 1 second! Tick **Auto-print every session**. Each guest receives a retro receipt strip instantly.

Customizing the Receipt Branding

Header & Monogram
Add the couple's names, event title, custom date, or venue name in bold retro monospace.

Photo Halftones
Booth renders 3 or 4 photos using Floyd-Steinberg dithering for sharp, distinct facial features.

Digital QR Code
A sharp QR code is printed at the footer so guests can scan to download the original full-color digital file!

Event-Day Checklist & Troubleshooting

Follow this pre-flight checklist before opening your booth to guests, and use these field solutions to quickly handle unexpected issues.

✓ 10-Minute Pre-Flight Checklist

- **Hardware Power:** Laptop charger plugged into reliable outlet. Tablet connected to mains power (or high-capacity power bank).
- **Camera Power:** DSLR plugged into AC dummy battery adapter — disable camera's "Auto Power Off" in menu.
- **Camera Focus:** Autofocus (AF) on guests initially, then switch lens switch to **Manual Focus (MF)** so focus never hunts.
- **Paper & Ribbon:** Ensure media is freshly loaded with at least 1 spare box in your event kit. Empty scrap cut bin!
- **Lighting Check:** Position ring light or studio flash strobe slightly above eye level. Take test photo to verify exposure.
- **Test Print Run:** Run 1 full guest session. Test the QR code scan on your phone and verify physical print cutting.

☆ Top 6 Quick Field Fixes

1. Guest phone says "Wi-Fi Has No Internet"
Normal on offline booths! Tell guests to tap *"Keep connection"* or *"Connect anyway"*. The phone downloads photos directly from the booth over local Wi-Fi.

2. Chrome Print Preview Dialog Appears
Open **photobooth4u-print-helper.exe** in the background. It intercepts print commands so prints occur silently with zero dialogs.

3. 2×6 Strips Not Slicing in Two
Open Windows/Mac Printing Preferences for your dye-sub printer. Ensure the **2-inch cut** setting is enabled and saved as default.

4. Receipt Print Appears Too Faint
Increase contrast in booth layout settings. On thermal printers, slow down the speed setting in preferences for darker, richer heat transfer.

5. Bluetooth Printer Disconnects
Keep the tablet within 5 meters of the printer. In tablet settings, disable battery saver mode for Bluetooth services. Tap Reconnect in Print settings.

Dedicated Technical Guides & Resources

Need deep-dive instructions for a specific printer brand or tablet configuration? Visit our dedicated guides online:

- **DNP Guide:** photobooth4u.netlify.app/how-to-print-dnp/
- **HiTi Guide:** photobooth4u.netlify.app/how-to-print-hiti/
- **Thermal Receipt Guide:** photobooth4u.netlify.app/how-to-print-thermal/
- **All Printers Directory:** photobooth4u.netlify.app/printers/
- **Laptop Print Station:** photobooth4u.netlify.app/print-station/

Need Fast Support During an Event?

Message us directly on Facebook Messenger at **m.me/roktetnachi** with your device model and error screen. Our technical team is ready to assist you!